

The Beer–Lambert Law

Pupil sheet

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. What I see on the screen

The screen shows **Illuminance** (in lux) and **Absorbance A**. **Only the illuminance is measured**; the absorbance is computed by the app.

Careful — the reference. Below the cards it says what I_0 is and whether it was *chosen* or merely *assumed* by the app. I put the **water blank** in the beam and press **Set reference I_0** . If the row says the app took it by itself, through something other than the blank, I take it again — which is why the activity no longer has to be restarted.

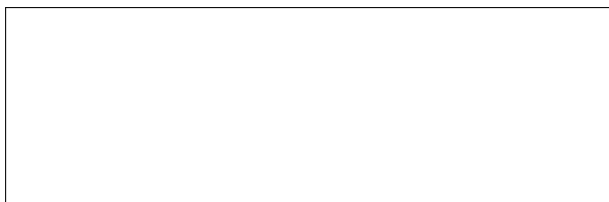
That is why I write the lux in the table, not the absorbance from the screen. From the lux I can rebuild everything; from the screen's absorbance I cannot.

I_0 (the blank) = _____ lx (write it down *before* moving on — it does not appear in the exported file)

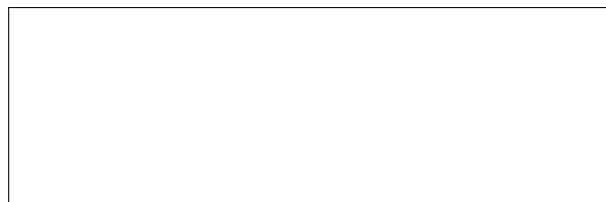
2. What I do on my own

First I predict, before any measuring. I draw two sketches. I add the real curve over them, in another colour, at the end of the lesson.

Transmitted light (I) against c



$A = \log_{10}(I_0/I)$ against c



The rig (measured once, then nothing moves): lamp-to-sensor distance _____ cm path length l of the cup _____ cm

I measure. The blank first. The volumes are already written in. **The first row is worked as an example** — I use it as the pattern for the rest.

c	Stock	Water	I (lx)	$T = I/I_0$	$A = -\log_{10} T$
<i>example</i>			<i>1000</i>	<i>0.50</i>	<i>0.301</i>
0 (blank)	0 mL	100 mL		1.00	0.00
0.2	20 mL	80 mL			
0.4	40 mL	60 mL			
0.6	60 mL	40 mL			
0.8	80 mL	20 mL			
1.0	100 mL	0 mL			
overconc.	—	—			
blank, at	0 mL	100 mL			
the end					

Check: $T = 10\%$ must give $A = 1$. If I get a negative number, I used percentages instead of a fraction.

The line. The gradient, computed on the linear points only: _____. The points leave the line from about $A \approx$ _____.

3. The conclusion I write

I predicted that, and the data show that _____

The logarithm straightens the graph because _____

Our instrument is trustworthy up to $A =$ _____, and above that, because _____

Exit ticket

Why does the logarithm straighten the graph?
